The "How was your day?" Project

Github repo: https://git.arts.ac.uk/23008862/Big-Data-2025

Website: https://cci.arts.ac.uk/~elowen/How_was_your_Day/

Introduction

- From mid-April 2025 - 15th of June 2025, I collected 200 responses to the question "How was your day?". This project's aim was to act as a public diary to promote self-reflection and mindfulness.
- The idea manifested as a digital diary that can be found here: (https://cci.arts.ac.uk/~elowen/How_was_your_Day/)
- As a side challenge to deepen my understanding of the data, I decided to ask participants about the region they responded from. This was to answer a personal hypothesis I have had: Does mood get affected by temperature?

Data collection

- I collected data via a survey. It asks if the participant is over 18 and consenting to the use of their data, which region of the UK they are responding from and the titular question "How was your day?"
- As this survey was targeted towards the general UK public, I decided to repost this survey on online forums such as Reddit. This required me to get the unit tutor and course leaders consent to do this, thankfully it was deemed as a low-risk survey. The Participant information sheet can be found here and the consent form here.
- I posted this survey on Reddit every day on sub-Reddit's such as r/SurveyExchange, r/SurveyZone and r/SurveyCircle. In addition to this, I printed out QR codes and placed them throught UAL's Greencoat building, Camberwell's Wilson Road and Peckham Road campus.

Data analysing

Here are the steps I took to analyse the data:

- Imported the csv, cleaned it and added code that will filter out submissions if they are under 18/nonconsenting and if there's any profanity used.
- Emotional Analysis using Michelle Jieli's emotion text classifier to get the response's background colour and to plot the emotions with matplotlib later-on.
- Used OpenAI's API call to prompt what RGB colour code they would give to each emotion from the emotion text classifier
- Utilised Open Mateo's Forecast tracker to get historical data on daily mean temperature
- BERTopic's topic identifier to identify response patterns and topics
- Matplotlib to plot a graph to see if there is any correlation between temperature and mood in the data.
- Finally, I created a website that showcased all the responses along with the date on submission, temperature and assigned colour.

FAQ

Why did you not use a regular sentiment analyser?

- I decided to use an emotion analyser instead to gain a deeper insight into the data as I felt it was more suited for the task at hand with the project fundamentally being about tracking emotions.

When getting the colour data, why didn't you go the Word2Vec direction?

- After analysing unit tutor Marysia Tanska's "week_07_text_to_emotion_to_colour" I was not able to identify any way to follow this example without using very similar code to hers as the aim of the example file overlaps completely with the projects aim. After continuous internal debates with myself about the issue I decided against it, instead using this opportunity to further develop my API skillset in the highly sought after OpenAI API.

FAQ 2

Why didn't you use the Open Weather API?

- I initially started by using this, this was before I knew you had to pay for certain datasets. After selecting the weather history API I noticed that I had to pay £7 for the UK's temperature history from mid-April to mid-June, I decided to buy this, thinking I can then specify which location to focus on code using the latitude and longitude. Unfortunately, this was for the UK in general and having already collected region data I went back on the website to input the 9 locations to get historical data on which totalled to £87. Luckily, I found that Open Mateo can do the very thing I needed for free.